

UNLEASHED LEADERS NOTES

THE PURPOSE

Our ministry rises and falls on the quality of leaders we have. They are the shepherds, leading our students. **Unleashed Leaders is your chance to ensure you are being diligent with who we let shepherd the sheep.**

Perfection isn't required in order to lead with us—but the calling and cost is high. Raising the bar on the front end is easier than trying to raise the bar later. **This is your chance to set the pace for the ministry you lead.**

01 TWO WEEKS

TWO PARTS, TWO WEEKS

Part 1 and Part 2 each get their own week. A good rhythm when training pairs with an existing program—leaders have time between sessions for the homework and for the content to settle.

02 TWO HOURS

BOTH PARTS, ONE SITTING

Run Hour 1 and Hour 2 back to back as a stand-alone training block. A good fit to kick off a school year or when a group of new leaders needs to be ready quickly—take a short break between the hours.

03 1 ON 1 / FEW

RANDOM INTEREST, ANYTIME

We never want a lengthy amount of time to pass when helping someone jump into our ministry. Just use the booklet when new leader interest arrives randomly during the year.

COMPANION RESOURCES

Unleashed Leaders Booklet · the training booklet

Unleashed Leaders Slides · aligned to these notes

4 Chair Inventory · homework + interviews

Unleashed Leaders One-Pager · recap & review

BEFORE YOUR FIRST TRAINING

BEST PRACTICES • WHEN TO RUN IT

BEFORE YOU TRAIN

This training utilizes the 4 Chair Discipling framework (Dann Spader) alongside the Unleashed Leaders booklet and slides. Familiarize yourself with 4 Chairs and the content before running a training.

BEST PRACTICES

- Use this New Leader Training process in tandem with all other clearance processes for leaders.
- Communicate that this training is to help them see if student ministry is a good place for them to be unleashed in their Kingdom work—**they aren't a leader until they are fully cleared, have completed this training, and we mutually agree it's a good fit.**
- When possible, slowing down the on-ramp over the course of 2 training times can help you get a better gauge of a potential leader.
- Resist the urge to fill gaps with any willing volunteer. **Good onboarding builds longevity. Rushed onboarding builds a revolving door.**
- Connect Unleashed Leaders to before or after the BIG 3 (Leader Launch = Aug, Leader Night = Jan, Leader Celebration = Year End).
- View HS / MS Camp as an on-ramp to leaders you want to come home and continue discipling their students—view UL in April / May as a starting line for them to jump in.
- Have a registration + check-in process.
- Know each participant's clearance standing when training so you can give clear next steps before and after training as needed.

POTENTIAL TIME SLOTS TO CONSIDER

BEST During the program they will potentially serve in. You quickly identify if they are available—free yourself to run it during Groups.

BETTER A stand-alone time that doesn't compete with anything else. People come in fresh and ready to dive in.

GOOD Between your service times on Sunday. Baked-in time they are already coming to church—catch them in the middle if time allows.

OKAY After church on Sunday. Convenient, but comes at a cost: tired, lull. You'll need to work to revive the room, especially if you run two hours.

BAD Skipping training. Allowing someone not to show up and being okay with it. Free-forming it.

WEEK 1 / HOUR 1

DISCIPLESHIP DEFINITION · MISSION · MODEL · TOOLS · ROLE

WEEK 1 / HOUR 1

Train from slides *NOT* booklet. Booklet is for notes.

ROOM SET UP Check-in · Water · Pen · Booklet · Your Special Touch (*Be set 15 minutes before people arrive*)

5 SET UP — Illustration to grab the room

- Share name + what brought you here + introduce staff present
- Booklet has a note section—no need to follow along in it.
- **ILLUSTRATION** Dollar store (40-60 piece) puzzle. Dump pieces on their tables. You keep the box.
- Give them **2 minutes** to complete as much as they can. Table with most completed wins a prize (*your choice*).
- This training is to give you a clear picture of disciple-making. **Hold the box up.** If you had the puzzle picture in mind, you would know what to do.
- Over the next 2 weeks / 2 hours we will learn how to make disciples in student ministry.
- Another picture we have: **143,556 students.** Most don't know Jesus—but change starts one student at a time.

10 MISSION + VISION — Jesus sets our mission

- **TABLE DISCUSSION** Why did Jesus come to earth? What was His mission?
- **Jesus Mission:** seek & save the lost (Luke 19:10) · make & multiply disciples (Colossians 1:6).
- **Southeast's mission:** connecting people to Jesus & one another—rooted in the Great Commission + Great Commandment.
- **Southeast's vision:** unleash the full force of the church to love people one at a time. We make a large church feel small, a large mission tangible. Student ministry is your place of being unleashed.

15 OUR MODEL — Jesus is our model

- **TABLE DISCUSSION** In your own words, define “disciple.” What are some things Jesus did to make disciples?
- **How Jesus did it:** chose Twelve (Lk 6:12–16) · regularly sent (Lk 9:1–6) · engaged the crowd (Lk 9:10–17) · always followed up (Lk 9:18–20) · raised the bar (Lk 9:23–27) · invested in a few (Lk 9:28).
- **What that means for us:** Small Groups—we choose twelve (ish) · Unleash—we send students out · Program—we engage the crowd · Intentionality—we follow up · Expectations—we raise the bar · One at a Time—we invest in a few.

10 TOOLS — what's at our disposal?

- Overview of what we do with STUDENTS.
- Overview of what we do for LEADERS.
- Point to your ministry calendar and dates where relevant.

10 YOUR ROLE — summary of your role

- Read through the role overview and extrapolate. **Then summarize:** Shepherd · Harvest Worker · Teammate.
- **1 Peter 5:2 → Shepherd:** be shepherds over God's flock—examples worth following.
- **Luke 10:2 → Harvest Worker:** Luke 9:62 calls us to grip the plow. Be a worker; call others to the work.
- **1 Corinthians 3:5–9 → Teammate:** each plays a part in planting, watering, tilling. God makes it grow—use your gifts for His Kingdom.
- **“You Win When”** = a student takes a next step toward Christ

HOMEWORK — 4 Chair Personal Inventory (*If doing two weeks, have them bring it back to Part 2*)

WEEK 2 / HOUR 2

4 CHAIRS · 4 CHALLENGES · REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY

WEEK 2 / HOUR 2

Have 4 chairs on stage to sit & move in

ROOM SET UP Check-in · Water · Pen · Booklet · Your Special Touch (Set 15 minutes before people arrive)

5 SET UP + 4 CHAIR OVERVIEW

- Recap as needed.
- Have 4 Chairs on stage as a visual. Consider explaining the overview while moving between chairs and explaining them for engagement.
- **Chair 1 = Lost:** everyone is born into this chair. "Lost" is the Biblical word used in Luke 15.
- **Chair 2 = Believer:** once we place our faith in Christ to forgive our sins we move to chair 2.
- **Chair 3 = Worker:** when you start fishing for people, harvesting the spiritual fields around you, you become a "worker."
- **Chair 4 = Disciple-Maker:** when you are personally reaching the lost, building up believers and equipping other workers, you have become a disciple-maker.

10 CHALLENGE 1 — "Come and See" · John 1:39 · John 1:46 · John 4:29

- Andrew tells Simon; Philip tells Nathanael. Invitation = come and see. Response = repent and believe.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** Who are the lost people that naturally cross your path each day?
- **REACH** = MS + HS CAMP · ONE NIGHTS · WORSHIP NIGHTS
- *Organically:* we send students every Wed/Sun to reach their schools, homes, and communities.

10 CHALLENGE 2 — "Follow Me" · John 1:43 · Luke 9:23 · Luke 9:57

- Challenge = lay down your life and follow Jesus.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** What does it mean to be a follower? What is expected of one?
- **BUILD** = GROUPS · WEEKEND WORSHIP · RETREATS
- *Organically:* building happens in the in-between moments—praying and reading with students as we go.

10 CHALLENGE 3 — "Fish for Men" · Matthew 4:19 · Luke 10:2

- Challenge = get after the work of ministry and fish for people.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** How do we know we're ready to be a harvest worker? What did Jesus look for?
- **EQUIP** = EQUIP WORKSHOPS · MISSION TRIPS · SERVING
- *Organically:* modeling mission for our students—are we going into the fields or just telling them to?

10 CHALLENGE 4 — "Go and Bear Fruit" · John 15:5

- Challenge = abide in Christ and bear fruit in making disciples.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** Where are you strongest? Where do you need to improve to produce much fruit?
- Chair 4 disciples aren't just small group leaders—they use every tool, alongside the Holy Spirit, to reach, build, equip
- **MULTIPLY** = INVESTING IN A FEW: NOT A PROGRAM, RAISING UP LEADERS
- **Each chair will be represented in your groups this year.** Your job: help students see where they are and get to what God has next.

HOMEWORK — check with staff on any clearance needs.

1 ON 1 / FEW

1 ON 1 / FEW Using the booklet when interest arrives randomly

Booklet-led—slides optional

— THE WALK-THROUGH

- There is a booklet and slides to guide the conversation. Use it to walk someone through a general overview of who we are as a ministry and help a potential leader get a feel for our expectations.
- Use your laptop or phone to show slides as a visual if needed. Or lean fully into the booklet.
- Keep it conversational—the same Mission / Model / Role / 4 Chairs content, sized for a coffee table instead of a stage.

— 4 CHAIR PERSONAL INVENTORY

- Ask the potential leader to fill it out before meeting—or after.
- Have them send you a photo of their results for you to review.
- Use these insights to help guide your interview and help you know how best to coach them going forward.
- The inventory confronts them with questions that identify where they are, and how our ministry can help them as they help others move to the next chair spiritually.

HSM + MSM SPECIFICS

OTHER ITEMS YOU MIGHT WANT TO COVER IN OR AROUND TRAINING

— COMMITMENTS

- **Weekly** — Groups, Huddles
- **Semesterly** — One Nights, Camps (Fall, Winter, Summer).
- **Yearly** — Leader Launch, Leader Night, Leader Celebration
- **Continual** — Investment in a Few.

— GROUP DETAILS

- Co-leader, Team, Grade
- Schools
- Communication (GroupMe)

— PARENT PARTNERSHIPS

- Communication.

— SAFETY

- Stoplight: Red, Yellow, Green Light
- Social Media / Online